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31 March 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-40031D
13 September 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TENT, OBSERVING, ASTRONOMIC, COMPLETE WITH FLY AND FRAME

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers one type and size of rectangular, gable roofed tent with fly and cover, supported over a wood and metal frame.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

T-T-871	- Twine, Cotton, Wrapping
T-T-911	- Twine, Fibrous, Jute
V-T-285	- Thread, Polyester
QQ-S-781	- Strapping, Steel, and Seals
TT-E-529	- Enamel, Alkyd, Semigloss
TT-P-595	- Preservative Coating, Canvas

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8340

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TT-P-1757	- Primer Coating, Zinc Chromate, Low Moisture Sensitivity
CCC-C-429	- Cloth, Osnaburg, Cotton
CCC-C-467	- Cloth, Burlap, Jute (or Kenaf)
DDD-L-20	- Label; for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-640	- Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-wall
PPP-S-760	- Strapping, Nonmetallic (and Connectors)

MILITARY

MIL-C-496	- Clips, End, Strap
MIL-W-530	- Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors
MIL-B-543	- Buckles, Tongueless and Web Strap
MIL-L-1709	- Lines, Tent
MIL-C-2399	- Cement, Liquid, Tent Patching
MIL-R-3390	- Rings, Dee
MIL-M-10578	- Corrosion Removing and Metal Conditioning Compound (Phosphoric Acid Base)
MIL-L-11075	- Loops, Strap Fastener
MIL-G-16491	- Grommet, Metallic
MIL-T-40625	- Tubing, Bias Sewn (Burlap or Osnaburg), Cloth
MIL-S-43770	- Snap Hooks, General Specification For
MIL-T-43566	- Tape, Textile, Cotton or Polyester, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors
MIL-C-43627	- Cloth, Duck, Cotton, Plied Yarns, Fire, Water, Weather and Mildew Resistant Treated, Lightdry Finish
MIL-S-43770/4	- Snap Hook, Cast Body, Fixed Loop Eye With Roller, Flat Spring Closure, Wide Mouth
MIL-W-44049	- Webbing, Textile and Tape, Textile, Polypropylene, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage

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* 2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government document forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

Department of the Army Field Manual FM 10-16 -
General Repair of Tents, Canvas and Webbing

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

5-4-469	- Tent, Observing (Astronomic, Ground Type, Magnetic, or Tower Type); Cover Assembly and Sections
5-4-470	- Cover Details
5-4-490	- Tent, Observing, Astronomic, Complete with Fly and Frame; Illustration, Sections and Views
5-4-491	- Body Assembly and Sections
5-4-492	- End Wall and Miscellaneous Details
5-4-493	- Frame
5-4-494	- Fly
5-4-497	- Erection Instructions
5-4-498	- Packaging Procedure

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

A 53	- Welded and Seamless Steel Pipe
D 2016	- Standard Test Methods for Moisture Content of Wood
D 3951	- Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103).

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(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.3).

3.2 Materials and components. Materials and components shall be as specified herein (see 6.5).

3.2.1 Cloth, duck, cotton. Cloth shall conform to the requirements of MIL-C-43627, and the color shall be Olive Drab 7.

* 3.2.2 Tape, textile, cotton. Tape shall conform to type I, class 4, 1 inch and 1 1/2 inch widths, Olive Drab 7 of MIL-T-43566.

* 3.2.3 Webbing, textile, cotton. Webbing shall conform to type IIb, class 4, 1 inch width, Olive Drab 7 of MIL-W-530. Alternatively, for cover only the webbing shall be polypropylene conforming to type IIb, class 4, Olive Drab 7 of MIL-W-44049.

3.2.4 Thread, polyester. The thread shall conform to type I, class 1, subclass B, dyed shade S-1 (CA 66022) of V-T-285. The dyed thread shall show fastness to weathering equal to or better than the standard shade sample (see 6.4). If no standard shade sample is available, the dyed thread shall show good fastness to weathering. Thread sizes shall be as follows:

a. For all stitching, except stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings - size FF for needle and bobbin.

b. For stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings - size FF for needle and size F for looper.

3.2.5 Lines, tent. The tent lines shall conform to type XXI, class A of MIL-L-1709. (NOTE: If manila rope should be in short supply, substitution with class B, C, D, E or polyester tent line in the appropriate size and construction shall be permitted).

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3.2.6 Buckles, tongueless, 2-bar. The buckles shall conform to type II, style 1, class 1 of MIL-B-543.

3.2.7 Clips, end strap. The end clips shall conform to type I, class 1, 1-inch width of MIL-C-496.

3.2.8 Loops, strap fasteners. The strap fastener loops shall conform to type I or II, style A, or type III, style B of MIL-L-11075.

3.2.9 Grommets, metallic. The grommets shall conform to type III, class 3, size No. 4 of MIL-G-16491.

3.2.10 Rings, dee. The dee rings shall conform to class 1 or 2, configuration K, size 1 x 3/4 of MIL-R-3390.

3.2.11 Snaphooks. The snaphooks shall conform to dash number MIZE 1 of MIL-S-43770/4 except that the roller shall be omitted.

3.2.12 Frame.

3.2.12.1 Wood. The wood used in the fabrication shall be thoroughly and uniformly dried to a moisture content of not less than 8 nor more than 12 percent at the time of fabrication and shall be tested as specified in 4.5.1. The slope of the grain of the cut wooden components shall not exceed 1 inch in 8 inches. All wood shall be free from decay, case hardening, shakes, checks, or any other defect. No more than two, sound, tight knots 1/2 inch or less in diameter or one knot more than 1/2 inch but not more than 3/4 inch in diameter will be permitted per linear foot. Any of the following woods may be used:

Ash, white	Hemlock, western	Maple, soft
Oak	Pine, Norway or ponderosa	Pine, (white) northern
Pine, southern (long leaf, slash, short leaf) and loblolly	Spruce (eastern, Sitka)	Tupelo, water
	Tupelo, black (black gum)	

3.2.12.2 Pipe, seamless steel. The pipe for ridge pole shall be standard IPS, cold drawn, steel, black, conforming to type S, grade A schedule No. 40 of ASTM A 53. The design and dimensions of the ridge pole shall be as shown on Drawing 5-4-493. The tests for chemical composition, tensile properties, bending properties, flattening, and hydrostatic requirements shall not apply.

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3.2.12.3 Bolts, nuts, and washers. The bolts, nuts, and washers shall be commercial quality, fabricated of steel with a protective coating of zinc and shall be in the design, type, and dimensions shown on applicable drawings.

3.2.12.4 Primer. The primer shall conform to composition G or L, as applicable, color Y or T of TT-P-1757.

* 3.2.12.5 Enamel. The enamel shall conform to class A or B, composition G or L, as applicable, of TT-E-529. The color shall be Olive Drab 24087.

3.3 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the drawings listed in section 2 and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitching, machine.

3.3.1.1 Types of stitching. All stitching types shall conform to FED-STD-751 as follows:

a. For all stitching except stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings - type 301, 5 to 7 stitches per inch.

b. For stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings - type 401, 5 to 7 stitches per inch. Chain portion of stitching shall not appear on outside of tent or cover.

3.3.1.2 Thread breaks. Thread breaks in stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch at each break on stitch type 301 and not less than 1 1/2 inches at each break on stitch type 401. Thread breaks noted during inspection shall be repaired by overstitched the existing stitching from a distance of 1 inch before the break to a distance of 1 inch beyond the break. The ends of repair stitching are not required to be backstitched. Thread breaks in type 401 stitching may be overstitched with type 301 stitching.

3.3.1.3 Stitching ends, type 301. The ends of 301 stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch, except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. Where stitching is performed automatically, stitch patterns such as box, box with cross-stitch, "W" stitching, or straight line tacking, 3 or more tying, overlapping, or back stitches shall be used to secure the ends of stitching.

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cloth, duck, center segment

3.3.1.4 Skipped stitches. Two or more consecutively skipped stitches occurring in type 301 stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch. Any skipped stitch in type 401 stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 1/2 inches. Skipped stitches noted during inspection shall be repaired as detailed above (see 3.3.1.2). Skipped stitches in 401 stitching may be overstitched with type 301 stitching.

3.3.1.5 Lubrication. The addition of any lubricant to the polyester thread prior to or during the sewing operation is prohibited.

* 3.3.2 Setting of grommets. Holes punched to receive grommets shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the grommet barrel so that the barrel must be forced through the hole. The grommets shall be securely clinched without cutting the materials. Roll of the clinched grommet shall not contain more than three scores (splits).

3.3.3 Setting of end clips. The webbing shall be inserted the full depth of the clips. The clips shall be securely attached without cutting the webbing, and the webbing shall be flat at the point of entrance.

3.3.4 Splicing of tape. When splicing is necessary, the tape used for facing shall be spliced as shown on Drawing 5-4-491. A maximum of one splice per observation opening will be permitted.

3.3.5 Compliance with the cup test. There shall be no seepage of water through the stitching when the tent is tested as specified in 4.5.2. Seepage of water at 2 or 3 points caused by hydrostatic pressure through needle holes or between the plies of a lap seam shall not be scored as a failure. The cup test is intended to ensure that nonwicking thread has been utilized and that no lubrication has been added to the polyester thread during the sewing operation.

3.3.6 Repairs. Any necessary repairs shall be effected in accordance with Department of the Army Field Manual FM 10-16, except that handsewn patches or cemented patches other than as specified herein will not be acceptable. Cemented patches on holes, cuts, or tears not more than 1 inch in diameter or length, using the cement specified in MIL-C-2399, shall be permitted. A maximum of three cemented patches per tent shall be allowed without prior authorization by the contracting officer. All other repairs shall require contracting officer authorization. Repairs required as a result of failure of the cup test shall be performed by treating with a compound conforming to type I, class 1, shade Olive Drab of TT-P-595, prior to retesting (see 6.9).

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3.3.7 Frame.

3.3.7.1 Ridge pole. The ridge pole shall show no splits or breaks when flattened or bent.

3.3.7.2 Finish. Prior to finishing, all wood surfaces shall be sanded smooth and thoroughly cleaned. The ridge pole shall be thoroughly cleaned and prepared for painting with a compound conforming to any type specified in MIL-M-10578. Following this surface preparation, the wood frame members and the metal ridge pole shall be coated on all surfaces (including ends) with primer specified in 3.2.12.4. When primer is thoroughly dry, the primer surfaces shall be coated with enamel specified in 3.2.12.5. The finish shall level out to a smooth, uniform surface without runs, wrinkles, grit, or areas of thin or no film.

3.4 Markings. All labels and markings shall conform to DDD-L-20 and as specified herein.

3.4.1 Special marking. The letters "US" on the tent, fly, and cover, and the identification marking on the cover shall conform to type IV, class 9 in the size characters and in the locations shown on the drawings. Class 9 markings shall be clearly legible after subjection to accelerated weathering.

3.4.2 Identification label. Identification labels shall conform to type VI, class 6 and shall be a minimum of 3 1/2 inches by 5 1/2 inches. A blank space of at least 1 1/4 inches shall be provided on the bottom of the label for the Department of Defense inspector's stamp. Identification labels shall be stitched to the tent, fly, and cover in the locations shown on the drawings.

3.4.3 Erection instructions. Erection instruction labels for the tent with frame shall conform to type VI, class 7 and shall be stitched to the tent and cover in the locations shown on the drawings. The label shall be a proportionate copy of Drawing 5-4-497 as reproduced from a glossy print of this drawing furnished by the contracting officer. The size of the label shall be 15 inches (± 1/4 inch) in the longer dimension with a minimum 1/2 inch margin outside of the borderline on all sides.

3.4.4 Marking of frame components. Frame components shall be marked as specified on Drawing 5-4-493. The marking shall be accomplished by die stamping, branding, or engraving prior to application of finishing materials and shall be legible after the enamel coating has been applied. Surfaces of the wood shall not be damaged by the marking operation.

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3.5 Workmanship. Cloth components shall be clean and free of holes, cuts, tears, or cloth defects such as multiple floats or broken or missing yarns. Webbing and tapes shall have no frayed or scalloped edges, and rope components shall be free of cuts or breaks. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose or tight stitching. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewn so that no run-offs, twists, pleats, or open seams shall result. Care shall be taken in sewing to see that no needle chews occur. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 1/2 inch or less in length. Metal components shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, or corroded areas and shall not be broken or malformed.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirement in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

* 4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), the complete tent shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.4 through 4.4.8 and tested for the characteristics specified in 4.4.9. The presence of any defect, any dimension not within specified requirements, or failure to conform to any test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Testing of materials. The moisture content of the wood (see 3.2.12.1) shall be determined in accordance with ASTM D 2016. The lot shall be 100 board feet or less, and the sample unit shall be a representative piece of lumber prior to milling. The inspection level shall be S-1, and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

4.4.2 Process examination. Examination shall be made of the following fabrication processes to establish conformance with specified requirements:

a. There shall be no lubrication of polyester thread prior to or during sewing operations for compliance with 3.3.1.5.
b. Holes punched to receive grommets are in compliance with 3.3.2.
c. Application of primer is in compliance with 3.3.7.2.
d. Drying of primer coat is in compliance with 3.3.7.2.

Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the process and all items processed.

4.4.3 Intermediate component inspection. The lots of intermediate components shall be examined in accordance with 4.4.3.1 and 4.4.3.2 and tested in accordance with 4.4.3.3.

4.4.3.1 Intermediate visual examination of frame components. Frame components shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of the following frame components: corner posts, side ties, end ties, roof supports, side diagonals, end diagonals, braces, and ridge poles after fabrication but prior to the application of the primer. The sample unit shall be one each of the different frame components. The inspection level shall be S-4, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0 for major defects and 15.0 for total defects.

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TABLE I. Frame component visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Wood members	Not specified species		201
	Knot hole or unspecified drill hole	101	
	Any knot, exceeding 3/4 inch in largest dimension	102	
	More than one sound, tight knot exceeding 1/2 inch but not exceeding 3/4 inch (in largest dimension) in any linear foot		202
	More than two sound, tight knots not exceeding 1/2 inch (in largest dimension) in any linear foot		203
	Decay or rot; evidence of brashness, case-hardening or compression wood; break or fracture	103	
	Bark or pitch pockets		204
	Any nonpermissible defect filled in		205
	Not sanded smooth, not clean or contains splinters		206
	Gouge, rough saw cut, torn grain, splinter or chip-out		207
Ridge pole	Not seamless, steel, black pipe		208
	Not formed to specified shape	104	
	Pipe is split, cracked, malformed or deformed	105	
	Any hole, except specified drilled hole	106	
	Break, sharp edge or uneven surface at bent and flattened area		209
	Burr or sliver		210
	Evidence of rust or corrosion		211

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4.4.3.2 Intermediate dimensional examination of frame components. Frame components shall be examined for the dimensions specified on Drawing 5-4-493. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of the following frame components: corner posts, side ties, end ties, roof supports, side diagonals, end diagonals, braces, and ridge poles after fabrication but prior to the application of the primer. The sample unit shall be one each of the different frame components. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.3.3 Intermediate testing of tent frame. Testing of the partially fabricated tent frame shall be performed for the slope of the grain of the wood as required in 3.2.12.1 in accordance with a standard commercial test method. The sample unit shall be one each of all wooden components after milling but prior to the application of primer. There shall be one determination per each segment of the sample unit and the results reported as "Pass or Fail". Requirements are applicable to the sample unit. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

* 4.4.4 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated tents with fly, frame and cover, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated tent, fly, frame, and cover. Tents shall be inspected in an erected position to make the interior easily accessible for examination. The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 10.0 for major defects, 40.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 100.0 for total combined major and minor defects.

TABLE II. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
			A B
Fabric	Broken or missing yarn, multiple floats, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance		X

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Fabric - continued	Cut, tear, or hole including exposed drill hole:			
	- greater than 1/4 inch in length or diameter:			
	- on tent	X		
	- on cover or sod cloth		X	
	- greater than 1/8 inch, but not greater than 1/4 inch in length or diameter:			
	- on tent		X	
	- on cover or sod cloth			X
	- not more than 1/8 inch in length or diameter:			
	- more than 20 holes:			
	- on tent	X		
	- on cover or sod cloth		X	
	- more than 10 but not more than 20 holes:			
	- on tent		X	
	- on cover or sod cloth			X
	- more than 5 but not more than 10 holes on tent			X
Webbing and tape	Edge frayed or scalloped			X
Hardware (tent and cover only)	Broken	X		
	Malformed:			
	- fails to perform intended function	X		
	- but will perform intended function		X	
	Corroded area			X
	Burr or sharp edge that may cause injury in handling or damage to fabric	X		
Grommets (fly only)	Improperly set, two or more teeth exposed (except where grommet is set as specified but is in an area of unequal thickness which prevents uniform clinching)			X

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Grommets (fly only) - continued	Clinched loosely, allowing grommet to rotate in hole			X
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting fabric	X		
	Insecurely clinched (i.e., grommet or washer may become disengaged)	X		
	Roll of a grommet contains more than three scores (splits)			X
End clips (on securing straps)	Not securely clinched, webbing not flat at point of insertion			X
	Clinched excessively tight cutting webbing		X	
Snap hooks (on door flap)	Spring tongue jams or fails to function properly		X	
Rope components	Any cut; any break on guy line		X	
Seams and stitching	Open seam on stitch type 301:			
	- for more than 1/4 inch but not more than 1 inch			X
	- for more than 1 inch		X	
	Open seam on stitch type 401:			
	- one row of stitching open for 1 inch or less on tent or cover			X
	- one row of stitching open for more than 1 inch:			
	- on body (roof and side walls)		X	
	- on end walls or cover			X
	- both rows of stitching open (not necessarily at same location):			
	- on body (roof and side walls)	X		
	- on end walls and cover		X	

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching - continued	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when one or more skipped or run-off stitches occur. On double-stitched seams, a seam shall be classified as open when either one or both sides of seam are open.			
	Raw edges caught in stitching:			
	- more than 1 inch but not more than 3 inches			X
	- more than 3 inches		X	
	Thread breaks or skipped stitches:			
	- overstitched less than 1 1/2 inches on stitch type 401			X
	- overstitched less than 1 inch on stitch type 301			X
	NOTE: Thread breaks or skipped stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.			
	Needle chew resulting in cut, tear, or hole (see cut, tear, or hole)			
	One or more required rows of stitching omitted (except on boxstitching and "W" stitching)	X		
Boxstitching	Incomplete:			
	- one row of stitching omitted			X
	- two or more rows of stitching omitted		X	
	Any boxstitching less than specified length by more than 1/8 inch			X

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching - continued				
"W" stitching	Incomplete:			
	- one row of stitching omitted		X	
	- two or more rows of stitching omitted	X		
	Any "W" stitching less than specified length by more than 1 inch			X
Stitching ends	Overstitched less than 1 inch on stitch type 301 (except where ends are held down by other stitching, turned under in a hem, or where stitching is performed automatically)		X	
	Secured with less than 3 tying, overlapping, or back stitches when automatic stitching is performed		X	
Seams	Seam pleated:			
	- on body (roof and side wall)		X	
	- on end walls			X
Seam type	Wrong seam type	X		
Stitch type	Wrong stitch type	X		
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in an exposed bobbin or top thread, for more than 6 inches		X	
	Tight, as evidenced by puckering on fabric, for more than 6 inches		X	
Stitches per inch	Less than minimum specified (except panel joining seams):			
	- one stitch			X
	- two or more stitches		X	
	Less than minimum specified on panel joining seams		X	

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor	
			A	B
Stitches per inch - continued	More than maximum specified:			
	- one stitch			X
	- two or more stitches		X	
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the fabric in order to sew over heavy places or heavy seams, or in turning corners, shall be classified as follows:			
	a. Within the minor "B" defect classification - no defect			
	b. Within the minor "A" defect classification - minor "B" defect			
Stitching gage	Not as specified		X	
Stitching margin	Larger than specified by more than 3/16 inch:			
	- for more than 2 inches but not more than 4 inches in length			X
	- for more than 4 inches in length		X	
Stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings	Chain portion of stitching shows on outside of tent or cover		X	
Mends, darns or patches	Repairs not in accordance with Department of the Army Field Manual FM 10-16 or not authorized by the contracting officer (see 3.3.6)	X		
Components and assembly	Any component part not fabricated of applicable referenced material	X		

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
			A B
Reinforcements	Improperly applied causing excessive fullness on reinforcement or reinforcement part		X
	Wall, eave and ridge reinforcements not continuous from end to end	X	
Hems	Constructed with partial turnunder when double turnunder is required	X	
	Twisted or pleated		X
Chapes	Snaphook and dee ring chapes on inside walls set out of alignment	X	
Construction detail defects			
Securing straps, tie tapes	Buckles on securing straps not assembled as specified; straps or tie tapes not attached to tent as specified	X	
Tent fly	Inner ends of corner cutouts not reinforced inside and outside with webbing reinforcements	X	
Flap	Inner edge of flap not securely caught in stitching attaching securing strap "A" to cover		X
Cover side flaps	Attached on outside of body in lieu of inside		X
General	Any other construction details not performed as specified	X	

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TABLE II. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Labels	Omitted, incorrect, illegible or misplaced:			
	- erection instruction		X	
	- identification			X
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible or misplaced			X
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains			X
	Thread ends not trimmed to 1/2 inch or less			X

4.4.5 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated tents with fly, frame, and cover, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated tent, fly, frame, and cover. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5 for major defects, 25.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 65.0 for total combined major and minor defects.

TABLE III. End item dimensional defects

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Overall dimensions of tent	Smaller than specified dimensions less applicable minus tolerance	X		
	Larger than specified dimensions and applicable plus tolerance indicated on drawings			X

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TABLE III. End item dimensional defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Dimensions:				
Components and openings (unless otherwise specified)	Under or over specified dimensions: - by more than 1/4 inch, but not more than 1/2 inch - by more than 1/2 inch		X	X
Hems	Hems required to finish less than 3/4 inch in width, less than specified; hems required to finish more than 3/4 inch in width, less than specified by more than 1/4 inch			X
Reinforcements	Finished dimensions less than specified by more than 1/2 inch			X
Walls, inside	Ends of guy line openings on roof overstitched less than 3/4 inch		X	
Roof, opening	Corners of roof opening improperly formed; outer edge of opening less than 26 1/2 inches or more than 27 1/2 inches from roof edge; roof opening less than 17 1/2 inches or more than 18 1/2 inches wide			X
Tent, inside	Finished edges of roof opening uneven with edges of webbing reinforcement or with edges of ridge band by more than 1/8 inch			X
Securing straps; tie tapes	Securing strap or tie tape less than specified length by more than 1/2 inch: - more than 1 but not more than 4 - more than 4		X	X

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TABLE III. End item dimensional defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor A B
Dimensions - continued			
Cover; flap, pocket and securing strap	Less than specified dimensions by more than 1/2 inch		X
	Set to cover, under or over specified dimensions by more than 1/2 inch		X
Locations dimensions (unless otherwise specified)	Under or over specified dimensions: - by more than 1/4 inch, but not more than 1/2 inch		X
	- by more than 1/2 inch		X

* 4.4.6 Frame visual examination. The completely fabricated frame shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated frames. The sample unit shall be one frame. The inspection level shall be I, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects, 10.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 40.0 for total combined major and minor defects.

TABLE IV. Frame visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor A B
Color and finish of frame members and ridge pole	Not enameled	101	
	Enamel is not a close match to the specified color		201

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TABLE IV. Frame visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	Minor A	Minor B
Color and finish of frame members and ridge pole - continued	Enamel is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, flaking or peeling		202	
	Enamel is not smooth and uniform, e.g., contains soft run or excessive hard runs			203
	Foreign matter imbedded in enamel			204
	Area of no film (including ends of all frame members), i.e., wood or metal exposed		205	
	Any area of thin enamel film (including ends of all frame members) i.e., prime coat showing through			206
	Finish removed by scratch, gouge or abrasion			207
	Area, marred during inspection operations, not touched up		208	
	Touch up not neat			209
Finish of bolts nuts and washers	Not zinc or cadmium coated	102		
	Coating is not adherent (e.g., is blistered, flaking, or peeling)			210
	Evidence of rust or corrosion			211
	Area of no coating			212
Construction and workmanship (general)	Any component missing, fractured, split, bowed, warped, or bent out of shape	103		
	Any operation omitted	104		
	Assembly hole missing or misplaced	105		
	Misdrilled or superfluous hole		213	
	Hole too large (permits carriage bolts to turn when nut is tightly drawn)		214	
	Hole too small (e.g., will not accommodate bolt)			215

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TABLE IV. Frame visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Bolts, nuts, and washers	Missing	106	
	Not specified type or size		216
	Thread stripped, damaged, or broken		217
Marking or die stamping	Missing, illegible, incomplete, not specified type or size, or not applied in specified location		218

4.4.7 Frame examination for defects in erection. A completely fabricated tent frame shall be examined for the defects listed in table V to determine the facility of assembly and erection. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated tent frames. The sample unit shall be one frame. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

TABLE V. Tent frame erection defects

Examine	Defect
Assembly	Any component or assembly that cannot be connected or joined with mating part
	Not readily assembled (i.e., assembling requires drilling or enlargement of holes, use of drift pin, or other mechanical means)
	Assembly hole missing or misplaced
	Undue force or special tool is required to effect assembly
	Component buckled or bent out of shape
	Any component missing (check all bolts, nuts, and washers)

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TABLE V. Tent frame erection defects - Continued

Examine	Defect
Assembly - continued	Component too loose or does not fit properly to mating component Component out of alignment

4.4.8 Examination of frame for dimensional defects. A completely fabricated frame shall be examined for overall dimensions. The lot size shall be examined in units of completely fabricated tent frames. The sample unit shall be one frame. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.9 Testing of the end product. Tent samples shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2 for compliance with 3.3.5. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated tents. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated tent. The inspection level shall be S-3. Failure in any area shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.10 Examination for frame count in intermediate bundles. Frame components bundled for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with bundle markings and specified quantity. The lot size shall be expressed in units of intermediate bundles. The sample unit shall be one bundle. Any bundle containing less than specified of marked quantity of frame components shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.11 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

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Examine	Defect
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Moisture content of wood frame members. The moisture content of wood frame members shall be determined in accordance with either the oven drying or the electronic moisture meter method specified in ASTM D 2016.

4.5.2 Seam leakage test. The tent shall be tested in three areas as follows: At the ridge, eave, or at seam joining end wall to body at gable end and panel lap seam on roof.

4.5.2.1 Procedure. Suspend the section of the tent containing the area to be tested between two supports (boxes, wooden horses) so as to allow both sides of the fabric to be viewed. The area to be tested shall then be cupped into a hoop 6 to 7 inches in diameter (e.g., an embroidery hoop) with the seam running through the center of the cupped fabric. Pour into the cupped area approximately one pint of cold tap water. Allow to stand for 5 minutes. At the end of the period, examine the test area. Evidence of seepage of water through the thread along that portion of the stitching exposed to the cup test shall constitute a failure (see 3.3.5).

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Tent and fly. Each tent and fly shall be folded and unit packed in the cover as shown in Drawing 5-4-498.

5.1.1.2 Frame assembly. The disassembled wooden members and metal ridge pole of the tent frame assembly shall be neatly stacked in a bundle. The base of the bundle shall be formed from the longest frame members, with the remaining members stacked in proportion to their length. Two bands of flat strapping 3/8 inch by 0.015 inch conforming to type I, class A of QQ-S-781

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or type II or III of PPP-S-760 shall then be applied around the bundle approximately 6 inches in from each end of the smallest or uppermost bundle member. The hardware and braces shall be placed together in an end opening, drawstring type bag made from unbleached cotton sheeting cloth. The four coiled guy lines shall be placed in a cotton cloth drawstring bag. Both bags, with contents, shall then be securely tied to the strapped bundle with cotton tape or twine or the drawstring of the bag.

5.1.2 Commercial. Tents shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing.

5.2.1.1 Tent and fly . One tent and fly, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting, cleated-plywood box conforming to overseas type, style A of PPP-B-601. Boxes shall be fabricated in accordance with gross weight and load type requirements as specified in PPP-B-601. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping in accordance with the requirements of PPP-B-601.

5.2.1.2 Frame assembly. One tent frame assembly, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting, cleated-plywood box conforming to overseas type, style A of PPP-B-601. Boxes shall be fabricated in accordance with gross weight and load type requirements as specified in PPP-B-601. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping in accordance with the requirements of PPP-B-601.

5.2.2 Level B packing.

5.2.2.1 Tent and fly. One tent and fly, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be wrapped and sewn in cotton osnaburg cloth conforming to class 2 of CCC-C-429 or burlap cloth conforming to class 3 of CCC-C-467. The wrapping shall be securely hand sewn with type I or II, 16-ply cotton twine conforming to T-T-871, or type I, size No. 2 jute twine conforming to T-T-911, with approximately one stitch to the inch and every third stitch overhand knotted. Alternatively, the bottom and side may be machine sewn. A minimum of five inches of wrapping material shall be gathered together on each of the four corners and securely hand sewn into ears for handles. In lieu of the sewn wrapping indicated above, bias sewn tubing conforming to MIL-T-40625 may be used. One end of the tubing may be machine sewn. The formation of handles shall be effected by hand sewing in conformance with method as described above. Wherever machine sewing is used, the thread type, stitch type, and number of stitches per inch shall conform to the requirements specified in MIL-T-40625.

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5.2.2.2 Frame assembly. One tent frame assembly, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting, cleated-plywood box conforming to domestic type, style A of PPP-B-601 or fiberboard box conforming to class 2, style A of PPP-B-640. The box shall be fabricated in accordance with the gross weight and load type requirements in the applicable box document. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced in accordance with the requirements of the applicable box document.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Tents, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.3.1 Additional marking. In addition to marking specified, the following shall be stenciled or imprinted on each cloth-covered bundle in characters not less than three-fourths of an inch high:

SEE ERECTION INSTRUCTIONS

SEWED TO INSIDE OF TENT COVER

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tent, observing, astronomic, complete with fly and frame, is used as a shelter in Army survey and mapping operations by the Army Map Service, Corps of Engineers. A cover is provided to protect the tent during transportation in the field.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.4).
c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

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6.4 Standard sample. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.5 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this document (see 3.2).

6.6 Components. The tent consists of the following components:

a. Tent, observing, astronomic
b. Fly, tent, observing, astronomic
c. Cover for tent, observing (astronomic, ground type, magnetic or tower type)
d. Frame, tent, observing, astronomic

6.7 Field component. The following component is required to erect this tent and fly, in the field:

Pin, tent, wood, 16-inch - 12 each

* 6.8 Repair. A satisfactory method of applying the textile compound for the repair of leaking seams is as follows:

a. A suitable volume of textile compound conforming to type I, class 1, shade olive drab of TT-P-595 (NSN 8030-00-290-4383) (55 gallons), shall be thoroughly stirred and diluted with an equal volume of petroleum solvent (Stoddard solvent or equivalent). Thoroughly stir the mixture again before use.

b. Prior to application of the compound, the tents must be dry. Special attention must be taken to insure adequate ventilation and that proper fire preventive measures are taken since the compound is flammable.

c. Two coats of the textile compound shall then be applied to the seams (on the outside of the tent only). A four-inch wide stiff brush is recommended for use. The first coat shall be air dried for a minimum of four hours prior to application of the second coat. Elapsed time between coats may be reduced by providing a supply of hot air to evaporate the solvent more quickly. In this manner, a second coat may be applied as soon as the first coat is dry to the touch. After the application of the second coat, the treated tent shall be allowed to air dry for a period of at least 24 hours.

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6.8.1 Seams to be treated. Seams which have failed the test specified in 4.5.2 shall be treated as follows:

a. - Failure at panel lap seams - Treat all panel lap seams.
b. - Failure at eave (except "W" stitching).

1. Stitching joining eave, or seam joining end wall to body at gable end - Treat all stitching on fabric eave.
2. Webbing stitching - Treat all webbing stitching on roof.

c. - Failure at ridge (except "W" stitching).

1. Stitching attaching ridge reinforcements - Treat all stitching on roof reinforcement.
2. Webbing stitching - Treat all webbing stitching on roof.

* 6.9 Subject term (key word) listing.

Shelter
Tent, observing, astronomic

6.10 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content, as written, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Review activities:

Army - MD
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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-T-40031E	Tent, Observing, Astronomic, Complete with Fly and Frame

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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